

Project Report-Out & Lessons Learned Document

Group E

Members:

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Business Need/Opportunity

The Opportunity As part of course-based learning activities, to work alongside the Community Foundation, OSI-CAN Saskatchewan, and Reach Autism Learning in exploring new and innovative web designs that allow these charities to efficiently and effectively communicate their organizations mission/vision/values, their programming/services, and calls to action. High-level guidelines, principles, constraints, & assumptions include:

- Design approach: Design Thinking (Agile)/Fast Feedback Cycle
- License: Creative Commons Share & Share Alike (CC BY-SA 4.0)
- Technology/Programming environment: StoriesOnBoard (Tim/Adam will be creating user accounts), Figma, WordPress, Local by Flywheel, GitHub (public repository required)
- Initial design notes o Basic website criteria
 - Home page
 - Engaging and inviting
 - Place to highlight relevant and timely content
 - Contact Page
 - Includes various ways to engage with the charity (phone number, email, address, social medias, etc.)
 - Call to Action Page
 - Must have a clear call to action (to donate, or engage in other ways applicable)
 - About Page
 - Who the charity is, their mission/vision/values, other information about the charity (how they started, who makes up their staff/board, etc.)
 - Programs/Services
 - Should be able to communicate what programs/services the charity provides to the public

Pain points:

- Make it clear that OSI-CAN support extends beyond Occupational PTSD, it also includes trauma not related to a person's employment
- Explore ways to organize and display their resources
- Make sure to still differentiate OSI-CAN resources from additional resources
- Make it easy to manage from a website maintenance standpoint
- Ways to effectively communicate programs/targeted information

Reflections on Project Planning, Execution, & Closing

- Our Northstar and Carryover customers were decided based on who the product was targeted at, the audience whose use of our product would be infrequent therefore secondary, as well as the audience that we expect to frequently use our product. As such, our Northstar customers were those who have experience work related trauma or mental and physical injuries looking for professional or peer support, as well as donors and volunteers who would like to support the OSI/CAN initiative. Our Carryover customers were those looking for support, or may have already found it and would like to keep in touch with the organisation, so they would most likely frequent the site.
- Assumptions made during the project initiation:
 - Design must be low-maintenance and low-budget to support the non-profit organisation as they will be the ones implementing and maintaining after the project ends,
 - Technology used would be such that is easily accessible to the client organisation and students, and
 - Frequent collaboration and communication between students and partners for ongoing feedback and updated content access.
- Constraints covered and explored in the design:
 - Accessibility: covering responsiveness of the design to technology changes (mobile and desktop/laptop interfaces), colors, font styles and size, navigation,
 - Design approach: iterative, Fast Feedback Cycle/AGILE,
 - Licensing: Creative Commons & Share-Alike (CC BY-SA 4.0),
 - Design: Basic website criteria, predefined logos and images,
 - Programs: Wordpress, Figma, StoriesonBoard, Github,
 - Deadlines: Oct 1 - Activity 1, Oct 15 - Activity 2, Nov 7 - Activity 3, Dec 5 - Activity 4
- From the empathy mapping of our clients, we developed the following conclusions:
 - The user's goals upon visiting the website were to obtain information regarding OSI/CAN, the services available to them, obtain information on who to contact in case of emergency, and to verify the legitimacy of the organisation.
 - The state of the user at the time of accessing the website was stressed, sensitive to overstimulation, and skeptical.
- Our affinity diagramming gave us insights as to the needs of the current website, what colors to change, how to reorganise certain pages that were in need of reorganisation, change the order and grouping of the menus, as well as consolidate similar aspects of the website that were misplaced.
- The initial USM of the website included affordances for the user like different features for wayfinding (breadcrumbs, integrated return buttons, etc), sorting of resources into "blogs" and "podcasts" and dedicated search on each page. The final revision however, did not have all these. The idea of breadcrumbs was scrubbed after it was deemed unnecessary and not worth the effort as the team found implementation challenging; we opted for sorting the resources by topic instead; and resorted to

implementing one global search feature across the whole website. The final wordpress solution is the MVP, as it satisfies the basic needs of the user as defined in our USM.

- Throughout our design, Wordpress was a consistent constraint, as it is significantly more restrictive than previous methods we used. This can be seen in our suicide hotline concept which did not make it to the final version, or our downloads section which was (at least to our knowledge) not easy to recreate in an intuitive way.
- Our group has focused heavily on accessibility in this design when it comes to colors. The constant red was a trigger to the primary consumer and as such was necessary to change.
- The team encountered challenges when implementing the wordpress design. As novices to the technology, implementing our envisioned design 1:1 with wordpress proved to be harder than we expected. This resulted in our final wordpress design having some differences with our prototypes, as we found it difficult to implement those features. The features we could not implement were the breadcrumb, and the collapsible emergency contact that was meant to be at the top of the page. We applied the concepts of design we learned in class to the prototype and final design, considering our constraints, consistency across the site, using calm and non-stimulating colours, fonts, and the gestalt principles. We took note of our client's feedback throughout, like changing the main color of the site from red to blue after noting that red was too triggering for users.
- One aspect of our design that was well received was the bubble design for the resources section, along with the rest of the page. In our final version of the design, this page is unfortunately left unfinished. The drop down menus were good, however they took a lot of time to figure out with how finicky Wordpress could be at times. These pages will mostly all look the same, so spending hours on filling out a design made little sense when having four pages function showed the idea just as well. We also did not finish the downloads page. The design for this page is really simple and effective in the editor, and translates better than the prior design for this page. However, when viewed on the website itself, it breaks, and the images don't load. We did not have the time to determine how to fix this, so after roughly an hour of failed troubleshooting we moved on to touch up other parts of the website.

Reflections on Project Results:

- The project tested our skills on lessons taught in class. Although it was stressful and difficult to balance with other school work, we enjoyed working as a team to rebuild something and put into practice the lessons taught in class.
- Our ability to work together to meet deadlines. Our group was good at coming together to finish up projects when we were behind. That went well. The making of the prototypes also went really well.
- The resources section is something we are proud of. While it does not have a search function, it contains a useful help line that guides people in a way that a search feature cannot, because it can guide people who do not know what resources they need. A search function needs you to know what you are looking for, this does not
- Our group was having some problems with navigating the wordpress software, we had some communication problems between members and one of our group members dropped out. These are some of the things that did not go well in our group
- As was mentioned earlier, we had some issues navigating the Wordpress software so, we weren't able to fully translate our prototypes into wordpress reality but for the most part it was successful.
- The people-centered design ideas discussed in lectures helped guide us during this process and we don't believe at any point that it was hindering. In our project there are many different concepts taught in class that have only helped us understand and serve our clients/users better.

In the future, we would do these differently:

- Create a lot of prototypes, Affinity Diagramming and Empathy Mapping. Create a questionnaire for our clients, to enhance communication.
- Try to work more as a team, manage our time better.

Wordpress Theme/Plugin Appendix

Akismet Anti-spam: Spam Protection

This plugin is rated 4.5 stars, was last updated 3 weeks ago as of submission, and has over 6 million active installations. The purpose of Akismet is to prevent spam comments and form submissions, so that both of these areas of the site are not used in a way to negatively impact the site's functionality. Especially important for forms in this site because of how important the forms themselves are.

Spectra

This plugin is rated 4.5 stars, was last updated 2 days ago as of submission, and has over 1 million active installations. This plugin allows for additional blocks to be used in wordpress and was used frequently in the website.

Starter Templates

This plugin is rated 5 stars, was last updated 1 week ago as of submission, and has over 2 million active installations. This plugin gave us the template we used for designing this website. We then built on what we were given and changed it to suit our needs.

SureForms

This plugin is rated 5 stars, was last updated 3 days ago as of submission, and has over 300 thousand active installations. This was a large part of creating the forms found throughout the site.

SureRank SEO

This plugin is rated 5 stars, was last updated 2 weeks ago as of submission, and has over 200 thousand active installations. This plugin generally helped with building the site.

Widget Options

This plugin is rated 5 stars, was last updated 1 month ago as of submission, and has over 100 thousand active installations. This plugin adds more options for designing the site with new widget options.

Theme: *Astra*

This theme is rated 5 stars, and was last updated recently (exact time unknown) as of submission. Astra is what we used to design the headers and footers for the site.